Pythagorean Theorem

Teacher's Edition

The Period

MA.8.GR.1.1 Apply the Pythagorean Theorem to solve mathematical and real-world problems involving unknown side lengths in right triangles.

Must Find a missing leg or the hypotenuse of a right triangle from $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$, the hypotenuse found first; an irrational answer exact and, when asked, to the nearest tenth.

Must not Stories (6.04); the coordinate plane (6.05); radicands over 225; simplifying a radical (√50 = 5√2 is Algebra 1 — a root's decimal is the answer); 3-D.

Target I can find a missing side of a right triangle — the hypotenuse, or a leg.

MTR **MTR.6.1** — Notes III and boards 3–4: every leg is checked against c · **MTR.4.1** — boards 4 and 6 split; the sixty-second re-vote · **MTR.5.1** — Notes I and board 5: one theorem however the triangle is turned

Segment	Slides	Time
Settle in; post the learning target	1	1 min
Warm-Up	2–4	6 min
Notes	5–7	11 min
Example 1	8–9	4 min
Your Turn	10–11	3 min
Example 2	12–13	4 min
Your Turn	14–15	3 min
Whiteboards	16–33	10 min
Independent Set	34	6 min
IXL	35	5 min
Total		**53 min**

Say these three things out loud today

1. Find the square corner first: the side across from it is c, the longest side.
2. The hypotenuse: square, add, then the root.
3. A leg: subtract the squares — and check it is shorter than the hypotenuse.

Slide by Slide

1. **Pythagorean Theorem.** Post the learning target.
2. **Warm-Up — On your own. No notes.** Q4 is Notes III's move before it has a name: $10^2 - 6^2 = 64 = 8^2$, the missing leg of the 6-8-10 triangle Notes II builds. *1 retrieves 6.01–02 — the Triangle Inequality, the last class (yesterday). 2 retrieves 5.10–11 — a unit rate used once (last week). 3 retrieves 4.05 — a perfect square's root (Unit 4) (two units back). 4 retrieves MA.7.NSO.1.1 — whole-number powers; a missing leg subtracts two squares like this (prior grade — the prerequisite this lesson needs).*
3. **Warm-Up — Answers.** Reveal. 1. No — 4 + 7 = 11 < 12 2. 81 pages 3. 14 4. 64
4. **Vocabulary — The new words, before they are used.** Read each word and its meaning once; the notes use them next.
5. **Notes — Copy the theorem and the picture.** Find the square corner. The side across from it is c.
6. **Notes.** Square, add, then the root. The root is the last step.
7. **Notes.** A leg is shorter than the hypotenuse. Always check.
8. **Example 1 — Find the hypotenuse.** Ask where the square corner is and which side is c before anyone squares.
9. **Example 1 — Worked.** 49 + 81 = 130, not a perfect square: c = √130, between 11 and 12 (121 < 130 < 144), and 11.40 to two places, so 11.4.
10. **Your Turn — Same steps, your numbers. Boards up when done.** 25 + 121 = 146 and √146 ≈ 12.08, so 12.1 — a board with 16 added the legs; a board with 146 stopped before the root.
11. **Your Turn — Answer.** Reveal; name what a wrong board most likely did (see the note above).
12. **Example 2 — Find a leg.** Ask which number is c before anyone squares: 15, the longest — so this time a square is subtracted.
13. **Example 2 — Worked.** 15 is c, so 15^2 stands alone: $b^2 + 64 = 225$, $b^2 = 161$, b = √161 ≈ 12.69, so 12.7 — and 12.7 is shorter than 15, as a leg must be.
14. **Your Turn — Same steps, your numbers. Boards up when done.** 121 − 36 = 85 and √85 ≈ 9.22, so 9.2 — a board with 12.5 added the squares (√157), longer than the hypotenuse.
15. **Your Turn — Answer.** Reveal; name what a wrong board most likely did (see the note above).

16–17. Board 1. A right triangle has legs of 9 cm and 12 cm. How long is the hypotenuse? → ***15 cm*** *21 — added the legs, not their squares [MA.8.GR.1.1: the theorem is about squares]*

18–19. Board 2. A right triangle has legs of 4 inches and 9 inches. How long is the hypotenuse, to the nearest tenth? → ***√97 in ≈ 9.8 in*** *13 — added the legs [MA.8.GR.1.1]; 9.9 — rounded twice, 9.849 → 9.85 → 9.9: round once, from the full value*

20–21. Board 3. A right triangle has a hypotenuse of 25 ft and one leg of 20 ft. How long is the other leg? → ***15 ft*** *32.0 — added the squares, longer than the hypotenuse [Notes III: a leg is shorter than c]*

22–23. Board 4. A right triangle has a hypotenuse of 41 m and one leg of 40 m. How long is the other leg? → ***A — 9 m*** *(B) stopped at $b^2 = 81$ and forgot the square root*

[Math Nation names skipping the final root]; (C) subtracted the sides, 41 − 40 [MA.8.GR.1.1: the theorem is about squares]; (D) added the squares instead of subtracting: about 57.3, longer than the hypotenuse [Notes III: for a leg, subtract] Split (no option near two-thirds)? Sixty seconds, convince your neighbour, re-vote, then reveal.

24–25. Board 5. Two sides of this right triangle are 5 cm and 7 cm. How long is the third side, to the nearest tenth? → ***√74 cm ≈ 8.6 cm*** *4.9 — subtracted, taking the 7 as the hypotenuse [Florida B1G-M, GR.1.1: misidentifying the hypotenuse]*

26–27. Board 6. A right triangle's hypotenuse is 20 inches; its legs are 16 inches and x. Which equation finds x? → ***D: $16^2 + x^2 = 20^2$, so x = 12 in*** *(A) the sides added, not their squares [MA.8.GR.1.1]; (B) the hypotenuse put with the legs [Florida B1G-M, GR.1.1: misidentifying the hypotenuse]; (C) squared the legs but not the hypotenuse — the 20 is a side too: 20^2 [Florida B1G-M, GR.1.1: calculation errors with the theorem] Split (no option near two-thirds)? Sixty seconds, convince your neighbour, re-vote, then reveal.*

28–29. Board 7. A right triangle has a hypotenuse of 14 m and one leg of 9 m. How long is the other leg, to the nearest tenth? → ***√115 m ≈ 10.7 m*** *16.6 — added the squares, longer than the hypotenuse [Notes III]*

30–31. Board 8. A pennant is cut as a right triangle with legs of 8 inches and 11 inches. The fabric costs 6 dollars. How long is its longest side, to the nearest tenth? → ***√185 in ≈ 13.6 in*** *The 6 dollars is not needed. 19 — added the legs [MA.8.GR.1.1]; 'cannot tell' — the longest side is the hypotenuse [Notes I]*

32–33. Board 9. Jo finds a leg of a right triangle. The hypotenuse is 13 cm and the other leg is 5 cm. She writes $\sqrt{(5^2 + 13^2)} \approx 13.9$. What went wrong? How long is the leg? → ***She added the squares; a leg must be shorter than 13 cm. Subtract: the leg is 12 cm.*** *'13.9 is fine' — no check against the hypotenuse [Notes III]*

34. Independent Set — Six questions. On your own, in writing. Hand out the Independent Set; the same six questions are on the board.

35. IXL — Last five minutes. IXL: every listed skill is required, SmartScore 67.

Variation. Boards 1–2: the hypotenuse, whole then to the tenth; 3–4 a leg, whole then the vote. The pattern breaks at 5 — the triangle turned — and 6 asks only for the equation; 7 is a leg to the tenth; 8 has the extra number; 9 is the check in writing. The independent set: a whole hypotenuse, one to the tenth, a whole leg from a big hypotenuse, a leg to the tenth, a turned triangle, the equation and its value.

Misconceptions to Watch

Board 1. 21 — added the legs, not their squares [MA.8.GR.1.1: the theorem is about squares]

Board 2. 13 — added the legs [MA.8.GR.1.1]

Board 3. 32.0 — added the squares, longer than the hypotenuse [Notes III: a leg is shorter than c]

Board 4. stopped at $b^2 = 81$ and forgot the square root [Math Nation names skipping the final root]

Board 5. 4.9 — subtracted, taking the 7 as the hypotenuse [Florida B1G-M, GR.1.1: misidentifying the hypotenuse]

Board 6. the sides added, not their squares [MA.8.GR.1.1]

Board 7. 16.6 — added the squares, longer than the hypotenuse [Notes III]

Board 8. 19 — added the legs [MA.8.GR.1.1]

Board 9. '13.9 is fine' — no check against the hypotenuse [Notes III]

Materials Whiteboards and markers. $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$ on the board for the period (memorized by the test). Calculators allowed, printed nowhere.